What to know for the campaign account

Friday 5 February 2027 | P2 | 40 minutes | Year A

Humanities | GROW | Spring 1 Week 5 | HUM-GROW-S1-W05

Learning outcome: Plan and write a structured historical account.

The Montgomery bus boycott took place in Alabama, USA, in 1955–1956. Black riders faced racist seating rules. Earlier requests, Parks's arrest, shared protest and a separate legal case all help explain the campaign. Your account will link the setting, reasons, events, results and why it mattered.

Part	What to include
Background	Montgomery, Alabama, USA, 1955–1956; unfair bus rules.
Causes	Long grievances and earlier requests; arrest as a trigger.
Key events	1 December arrest; 5 December boycott; 1956 court case; 20–21 December end and return.
Consequences	Changed bus rights by the end; networks and example in later years.
Significance	Shared action and legal work mattered. No single-hero account.

Keep the facts clear

Parks's arrest was on 1 December 1955. The boycott began on 5 December. Browder v. Gayle was a separate legal case; Parks was not a plaintiff. People returned to integrated buses on 21 December 1956. Racism did not end.

A structured account

Use five short paragraphs. Choose dates, facts and reasons. Explain a cause, a result and why the campaign mattered, with a limit. No word target replaces clear thinking.

Historians and museum staff plan clear accounts from evidence and explain their limits.